



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Channel Management

ENTREPRENEURSHIP SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of channels of distribution.
2. Explain the relationship between customer service and channel management.
3. Evaluate channel members.
4. Explain the role of promotion as a marketing function.
5. Coordinate channel management with other marketing activities.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the founder and owner of EDU-PRINT, a small business specializing in printing and distributing textbooks for high schools and colleges. Your mentor (judge) has suggested that you explore a new distribution channel: partnering with online educational platforms to offer print-on-demand services. You must explain how adding this channel would benefit EDU-PRINT and expand your customer base.

EDU-PRINT currently prints and distributes textbooks by working directly with educational institutions. Your company provides high-quality printing services, including custom textbook designs, durable binding, and eco-friendly paper options. EDU-PRINT has built strong relationships with several high schools and colleges, but business is limited to bulk orders and direct sales to institutions.

Your mentor (judge) believes that partnering with online educational platforms (like digital course providers or e-learning companies) to offer print-on-demand services could significantly expand your reach. This would allow EDU-PRINT to cater to individual students and smaller organizations that prefer physical textbooks over digital versions.

You must present your analysis of how EDU-PRINT could benefit from this partnership. You will need to explain how the print-on-demand model works, how to choose the right educational platforms to partner with, and how this new channel could increase both revenue and customer satisfaction. Additionally, you should consider any logistical challenges and how to measure the success of this channel.

You will present your analysis and plan to your mentor (judge) in a role-play that takes place in their office. Your mentor (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your analysis and answered your mentor's (judge's) questions, your mentor (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How do you plan to handle potential logistical challenges, such as managing small, individualized print orders while maintaining efficiency and profitability?
2. How would you market this print-on-demand service to individual students and smaller organizations, considering many are used to digital textbooks?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of channels of distribution?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Explain the relationship between customer service and channel management?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Evaluate channel members?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Explain the role of promotion as a marketing function?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Coordinate channel management with other marketing activities?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						